

A Supersonic Journey: From 'Make-In-India' to 'Make-for-the-World'- BrahMos

India, commanding one of the largest and powerful Armed Forces in the world, has confronted complex security dynamics owing to its history and geography. Achieving strategic autonomy in the highly critical defence sector has acquired urgency to fortify national security and territorial integrity.

The country's Tri-Services undergoing comprehensive modernisation, have augmented their operational readiness by inducting new-generation platforms, state-of-the-art weapons and systems in alignment with the flagship 'Make-In-India' drive aimed at defence indigenisation.

As contemporary warfare evolves rapidly with swift advancements in modern military technology, a unique, state-of-the-art weapon BRAHMOS in the arsenal of India's Tri-Services has hugely bolstered the country's security architecture. The supersonic cruise missile with its unparalleled parameters of range, precision, firepower, maneuverability and stealth, has positioned itself as a powerful 'game-changer' in modern war dynamics.

The remarkable rise of BRAHMOS as the best and deadliest precision strike weapon having the 'universality' to influence multi-domain war operations from land, sea and air has made it an indispensable tactical asset of Indian military. With its active deployment in Army, Navy and Air Force, BRAHMOS has galvanized India's network-centric warfare capability in multi-threat combat environment.

As a high-end weapon combining cutting-edge technologies, sophisticated design and superior operational prowess, BRAHMOS has outwitted all other tactical systems in the world.

The development of BRAHMOS as a joint venture military-technology programme involving India's DRDO and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya has become the brightest spot in modern India's military domain. The JV entity BrahMos Aerospace which designs, develops and produces the universal weapon, has carved a niche in the world today. In over the two and half decades of its momentous journey, BrahMos has charted glorious milestones and achieved many "firsts" for the nation.

Since its maiden successful test launch undertaken in anti-ship mode in June 2001, BRAHMOS has

continuously evolved and incorporated innumerable advancements to retain its supremacy as a formidable system.

The missile's land-attack variant deployed with Indian Army in advanced Block I, II and III configurations has bolstered India's land warfare capability from highly complex, widely varied land terrains. Indian Navy's frontline maritime platforms armed with BRAHMOS anti-ship and land-attack configurations have established their indomitability in maritime fronts.

As Indian Air Force's most powerful precision strike 'stand-off' airborne weapon integrated on Sukhoi-30MKI fighter platform, BRAHMOS air-to-surface missile has validated its prowess to undertake air combat operations from 'beyond visual ranges' to neutralise both ground and sea-surface targets in all-weather, day-and-night conditions.

With its successful operationalisation across the spectrum of land, sea and air, BRAHMOS has rendered India the distinct capability to become the first and only nation in the world to complete 'supersonic cruise missile triad'.

Aligning with India's aspiration to achieve self-reliance in defence production and indigenisation, BrahMos JV has successfully marched ahead to realise new breakthroughs in the BRAHMOS development programme.

In coordination with DRDO, BrahMos has successfully indigenised several key technologies, components and sub-systems in the missile, thus significantly enhancing its overall performance parameters while reducing the production, operation and maintenance costs.

As a proud flagbearer of 'Make-In-India', BrahMos has established a robust defence eco-system in India through the 'Missile Industrial Consortium' framework.

The Indian defence industry has been playing a pivotal role in the BRAHMOS development, production and integration work. The synergistic efforts among a large number of public & private sector organisations, laboratories and institutions and their immense contribution have made BRAHMOS a weapon par-excellence.

In January 2022, supersonic BRAHMOS heralded a watershed moment in India's defence exports front

when BrahMos Aerospace signed a historic deal with the Republic of Philippines to supply shore-based BRAHMOS anti-ship missiles to the Philippine Navy.

As a champion of 'Make-In-India', BrahMos thus proudly stepped into the 'Make-for-the-World' realm. With this landmark deal, supersonic BRAHMOS carved its global foothold and became India's first full-scale weapon to receive multi-million dollar export order.

BrahMos Aerospace has started preparing to deliver the weapon and associated systems to its first foreign customer nation in accordance to the contractual timeline.

As India's quest to become a developed nation in the foreseeable future gains momentum, the unstoppable journey of BRAHMOS will continue with the advent of new futuristic variants of the weapon which would prepare and empower the Tri-Services of the nation for the battlefields of tomorrow.

